NEW HIRE ONBOARDING

Training Curriculum & Reference Guide

Welcome to Woof Gang! Work through each module with your trainer. Safety training is required before independently handling dogs.

Training sequence: Safety; Team & Brand; Role; Grooming Services & Pricing; Phone; Check-In; Check-Out; Schedule; Incidents; Retail; FranPOS; Inventory; Complaints; Store Policies; Daily Routines; Payment Policy; Final Skills Check.

1. SAFETY PROTOCOLS - REQUIRED FIRST

Safety Protocols

and emergency response steps.

Review all 5 Safety Protocols. Ensure the new hire has signed the WGB Safety Protocol.

In-Store Handling & Leash Safety

Never Leave a Dog Unattended

A dog should never be left alone - not on a grooming table, not in the bath, not walking through the store. If you need to step away, get another team member to take over first.

Always Use a Lead

Every dog moves through the store on a lead - from the lobby to the back, kennel to bath, bath to grooming table. No dog is ever carried loose or walked hands-free.

No Collars or Leashes in Kennels

Never leave a dog in a kennel with a collar or leash on - this is a strangulation hazard.

Doors Stay Closed

All doors in and out of the back must remain closed at all times - a door left open is how a dog gets loose.

Safety Management - Weekly

- Conduct a Safety Pause: 5-minute weekly discussion on core safety behaviors.
- 100% follow-up on any incident within 24 hours.
- Ensure all team members are familiar with and have signed the WGB Safety Protocol.
- Management confirms which roles require AKC certification and tracks applicable completion deadlines.

I Topic completed - trainer initials: _____ Date: _____

Trainer initials: _____ Date completed: _____

Team Introduction

team.

Introduce the new hire to every team member. Explain each person's role, responsibilities, and how the team works together.

Meet the Team

- Kyle & Julie Hoberman - Owners: Set the overall direction for the stores.
- Your store manager: Your first contact for daily questions and shift issues.
- Groomers: Handle all grooming and bathing services - full grooms, baths, spa upgrades, and add-ons.
- Bathers: Handle bathing, drying, and brushing (not every store has a dedicated bather).
- Sales Associates: The retail and front-desk team - first point of contact for customers, handling check-in/check-out, bookings, and retail sales.

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Brand Mission & Values

Share the brand story and commitment to pet wellness and customer service. Every pet deserves a happy and healthy life of quality while looking good!

The Woof Gang Way - Philosophy

Our Mission

"We believe every pet deserves a happy and healthy life of quality while looking good!"

What Sets Us Apart

We hold ourselves to the highest standard of safety for every pet in our care, while maintaining the highest standard of customer care for every person who walks through the door. We take the best of what big box pet stores offer and combine it with the warmth and personal touch of a locally-owned shop.

Pack Rules

- First Impression: A friendly greeting, helpful support, and clean store make guests feel welcome - leading to more bookings, purchases, and long-term loyalty.
- Customer Experience: Delivering a positive experience builds trust and encourages repeat visits.
- Store Presentation: A clean, welcoming store reinforces our boutique atmosphere.

Customer Care Language

- Instead of "No" - say: "I'm very sorry about how you feel. Here is what we can do____."
- Instead of "I don't have availability" - say: "I'm sorry I don't have that date; how about (date)?"

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Your Role as a Sales Associate

the person who ties the whole in-store experience together.

You set the tone for every visit. Greet warmly, stay attentive, and make sure every customer - whether there to shop, book, or drop off for grooming - feels taken care of from the moment they walk in.

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Trainer initials: _____ Date completed: _____

Grooming Services Overview

size/coat, time differences, Spa upgrades, and walk-in policies.

Review all service types and waivers: General, Senior, and Shave Down. Pricing is never quoted over the phone - groomers assess size, weight, and coat condition at check-in.

Service Descriptions

Full Groom

Full-style haircut, bath with shampoo & conditioner, hand drying, full-body brushing & styling, nail clipping & filing, gentle ear cleansing, sanitary trimming, and anal glands expression as requested.

Mini Groom

Bath with shampoo & conditioner, hand drying, full body brushing & styling, nail clipping & filing, gentle ear cleansing, sanitary trimming, and trimming of the face, paws, tail, ears, and sanitary area only. Does not include a full body haircut.

Luxury Bath

Bath with shampoo & conditioner, hand drying, nail clipping, filing, gentle ear cleansing, and full body brushing & styling. Does not include a haircut.

Classic Bath

Bath with shampoo & conditioner, hand drying, gentle ear cleansing, and full body brushing & styling. Does not include a haircut.

Spa Upgrades

- Hairy Beast (Deshedding): Deep deshedding treatment - recommend for heavy-shedding breeds.
- Diamond Dog: Brightening treatment - leaves coat glossy, clean, and bright.
- Blueberry Pie Facial: Facial treatment for the face/beard/eye area; helps with tear staining.
- Plush Pup: Leaves coat extra soft and silky to the touch.
- The Teddy Bear: Adds volume and fluff - popular on doodles and fluffy breeds.

Add-Ons

- Teeth Brushing: Brush the dog's teeth to help with breath and dental health.
- De-Matting: Removes mats and tangles - priced per 10 minutes. Flag heavily matted dogs early.
- Nail Polish / GEL: Applied after nail trim - GEL lasts longer.
- Anal Glands: Manual expression, offered as requested.
- Flea & Tick Shampoo: Medicated shampoo for dogs with fleas or ticks.
- Handling (Extra Care): Additional time for anxious, elderly, or difficult-to-handle dogs.

Dog Grooming Booking Checklist

- Dog Size: Ask for size (small, medium, large, extra-large) - affects time and pricing.
- Coat Type: Identify coat type (curly, straight, long, short). Doodles take longer.

- Groomer Experience: Not every groomer does Cat Grooming or Hand Stripping - confirm before booking.
- Health & Age: Check for health concerns or elderly dogs requiring special handling.
- Rabies Vaccination: Remind owners to check expiration before the appointment.
- Pricing: Never quoted over the phone. Services "start at" a certain amount.
- Schedule Balance: Avoid too many similar breeds in one day.

REQUIRED PRICING CHECK

- Prices depend on actual weight and coat type. Groomers must weigh each dog, assess its coat, and ensure both fields are correct in FranPOS before service.
- Sales associates collect preliminary details at booking. Any price changes must be communicated and approved before grooming begins.

Trainer initials: _____ Date completed: _____

TRAINING MODULE 5

Walk-Ins

What Counts as a Walk-In

Nail trims and teeth brushing don't require an appointment - customers can walk in for these any time during store hours.

When Someone Walks In

Ask which groomers are available. A groomer can safely put their current dog aside for a few minutes to handle a walk-in.

Log It in the Schedule

Even without an advance booking, add the visit to the schedule once it's done - this keeps records accurate and the groomer's work tracked.

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Answering the Phone

on missed calls - with a consistent, warm tone every time.

The phone is often a customer's first impression of the store. Review the standard greeting, the phone booking flow, confirmation calls, and voicemail follow-up so every call sounds like Woof Gang, no matter who picks up.

The Greeting & Phone Etiquette

Answer By the 3rd Ring

The phone is often a customer's very first impression - answer promptly. Never let it ring to voicemail if you're able to answer.

Standard Greeting

"Thank you for calling Woof Gang Bakery & Grooming (store name), this is (your name) - how can I help you and your

pup today?"

Tone

- Smile through the phone - customers can hear it. Warm, upbeat, unhurried, even when the store is busy.
- Use the pet's name once you have it.
- Never rush a caller off the phone.

Placing a Caller on Hold

Always ask permission first - "Can I put you on a brief hold while I check that?" - and check back within about 30 seconds.

Booking a Grooming Appointment - Script

Step 1 - New or Existing Customer?

Ask for the pet parent's name and phone number and look them up in FranPOS.

Step 2 - Get the Dog's Details (New Customers)

- Breed & size: small, medium, large, extra-large.
- Coat type: curly, straight, long, short.
- Temperament: any handling concerns, anxiety, or health issues.
- Last groomed: how long ago and where - helps flag a dog that may need de-matting.

Step 3 - Ask What They're Looking For

Full Groom, Mini Groom, Luxury Bath, or Classic Bath. Never quote a firm price over the phone. Services "start at" a listed price; the groomer confirms exact pricing at check-in.

Step 4 - Rabies Vaccination

Remind every new customer that a current rabies vaccination record is required before the appointment.

Step 5 - Confirm & Close

"Great - we'll see you and (Dog's Name) on (Day) at (Time) with (Groomer). Please plan to arrive 5–10 minutes early to

get checked in."

Confirming an Appointment - Script

"Hi, this is (your name) calling from Woof Gang (store name) - I'm just confirming (Dog's Name)'s appointment tomorrow at (time) for a (service) with (groomer). Does that still work for you?"

Trainer initials: _____ Date completed: _____

TRAINING MODULE 7

If They Need to Reschedule

"No problem at all - let's find something that works better. I have (option A) or (option B), which is better for you?"

If It Goes to Voicemail

"Hi, this is (your name) from Woof Gang, just confirming (Dog's Name)'s appointment tomorrow at (time). If anything's changed, give us a call back at (store number) - otherwise we'll see you then!"

Missed Calls & Voicemail - Script

The Rule: Same-Day, Every Time

Return missed calls by close of business whenever operationally possible; flag unresolved calls for management.

Returning a Missed Call

Before calling back, check FranPOS for the phone number - if they're an existing customer, you'll already know their pet's name and history.

"Hi, this is (your name) from Woof Gang (store name), returning your call - sorry we missed you! How can I help you

and (Dog's Name) today?"

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Trainer initials: _____ Date completed: _____

Check In

pricing and spa upgrades get communicated, and which waivers need a signature before the groom starts.

Every dog gets weighed and coat-assessed the moment it's in the back, and every check-in builds trust before the groom even starts.

The Check-In Process

Before the Pet Arrives

- Check the pet's profile for notes - styling requests, health conditions, behavior notes.
- Review any requested add-ons so nothing gets missed later.

Greeting the Pet Parent

Warm, sincere smile - bend down to the pet's level and use the pet's name.

Assessing the Service

- Confirm what the customer is requesting and set clear expectations.
- Every dog must be weighed and have its coat assessed immediately once it's in the back - this is what makes pricing accurate. Never optional.
- Highlight relevant Spa Upgrades - this is a normal part of check-in, not an upsell tacked on at the end.

Quoting the Price

Always call out any additional cost from spa upgrades or add-ons up front - a pet parent should never be surprised by the total at checkout.

Shave-Down Agreement & Fees

Extra Brushing - $10 per 10 Minutes

If minor matting can be safely brushed out, offer de-matting in 10-minute increments. Only de-mat for 10 minutes at a time for the pet's safety.

Partial Shave-Down (Specific Area) - No Fee

If a specific area can't be saved but the rest of the coat can stay fluffy, explain clearly at check-in - no fee for a partial, localized shave.

Full Shave-Down - $15

Explain why to the pet parent at check-in and have them sign the shave-down waiver before any shaving begins. We never shave a dog without a signed waiver.

Senior Dog Waiver

When It's Required

Have a Senior Dog Waiver signed for any dog the groomer or Sales Associate flags as elderly or higher-risk.

How to Handle It at Check-In

- Explain to the pet parent, plainly and kindly, why the waiver applies.
- Have the pet parent sign before the groom begins.
- Note any specific health or mobility concerns in the dog's profile.

I Topic completed - trainer initials: _____ Date: _____

5-MINUTE / 15-MINUTE POLICY

- At 5 minutes late, call and text the customer and notify the groomer.
- At 15+ minutes late, consult the groomer; management decides whether to accommodate, modify with customer consent, or reschedule. Never rush a dog.

Trainer initials: _____ Date completed: _____

Check Out

parents, and why rebooking happens every single time.

Every dog gets a final once-over before pickup, and every customer leaves with their next appointment on the books. No exceptions.

Check-Out Checklist & Rebooking

Before the Pet Leaves

- Cotton balls out of the ears - always double check.
- Confirm every add-on requested was actually completed.
- Bandana on - every dog leaves with a little Woof Gang touch.
- Finishing spray applied for that fresh, just-groomed scent.
- Match the dog's name to the correct leash before handoff.

Communicating with the Pet Parent

- Text the pet parent about 15 minutes before the groom wraps up.
- Make sure the pet parent is thrilled - offer a free immediate touch-up for any concern.

Rebooking - Non-Negotiable

- Every customer, every time, no exceptions - recommend when to see the pet again before they leave.
- Typically recommend 4–6 weeks for doodles, poodles, and any dog that needs consistent grooming.
- Offer a mini groom or luxury bath to bridge the gap between full grooms.
- Provide the completed Pup's Spa Day Report and ask for a Google review.

PRO TIP: Don't ask "Would you like to rebook?" - that makes it easy to say no. Instead: "I can get you all set for your

next appointment, 6 weeks from now."

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Trainer initials: _____ Date completed: _____

Managing the Schedule

knows how to handle a late arrival without throwing off the rest of the day.

Every open minute on a groomer's schedule is money left on the table - for the store and for them. Book tight, start on time, and use good judgment when a customer runs late.

Booking Tight - Every Minute Counts

Start Exactly on Time

If a groomer starts at 9:00, their first dog should be booked for 9:00 - not 9:30. A gap at the start of the day never gets recovered.

Every Unbooked Minute Is Lost Revenue

An empty slot on the schedule is lost money for the store, and lost income for the groomer who's paid on commission. Book tight and keep the whole day full.

Handling a Late Arrival

5 Minutes Late - Reach Out

If a customer is 5 minutes past their appointment time, call and text them to check where they are.

15+ Minutes Late - Use Discretion

Talk to the groomer. Depending on how tight the rest of the day is, you may still fit the dog in as scheduled - or adjust to a shorter service to keep the rest of the day on track.

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Trainer initials: _____ Date completed: _____

Handling Accidents

Reporting an accident in good faith is never grounds for discipline - but there's a clear process to follow every time:

notify, document, and communicate with the pet parent.

How We Handle an Accident

Open-Door Policy

Employees will not be disciplined for reporting an incident in good faith. Unsafe conduct is reviewed separately. What matters is how we handle it when one happens.

Step 1 - Notify

The groomer must immediately tell Kyle, Julie, or Cindy - no matter how minor it seems.

Step 2 - Document

Take a clear picture of the situation for documentation purposes.

Step 3 - Owner/Manager Follow-Up

It's the owner or manager's responsibility to understand what happened and call the pet parent as soon as possible.

Step 4 - Communicate at Checkout

When the pet parent arrives for pickup, the groomer talks through what happened with them directly.

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Trainer initials: _____ Date completed: _____

Retail Product Knowledge

Highlight treats, toys, and grooming products. Emphasize USA-made brands where applicable. Keep treat tables clean, organized, and fully stocked throughout the day.

Retail & Inventory - From Playbook

Daily Tasks (Sales Associate)

- Keep treat tables clean, organized, and fully stocked throughout the day.
- Keep the cash wrap area clean and inviting.

Weekly Tasks (Owner/Manager)

- Order weekly for a steady inventory flow - ensure items are always in stock.
- Review Inventory & Pricing Guidelines.
- Make ordering decisions based on data (Sales Report).

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Trainer initials: _____ Date completed: _____

leave them.

A clean, fully-stocked floor with no holes on the grid is part of the customer experience, not a side task.

Keeping the Floor Clean & Merchandised

Always Clean

The store should always be clean and presentable. If a dog has an accident, clean it up immediately with disinfectant.

Merchandising

- Push product to the front of the pegs - a full-looking display sells better than a half-empty one.
- No holes on the grids. If a spot sells out, find something else to fill it.
- Every item should be labeled, and the price should always match what's in FranPOS.
- Face the product - labels and logos turned outward toward the customer.
- Rotate stock (FIFO): older product moves to the front, new product goes to the back.
- Check for expired or damaged product while restocking and pull anything expired.

Cookie Table

The cookie table should always be well stocked - it's one of the first things customers see.

Out of Stock?

If items are missing or out of stock, tell Cindy or Kyle - don't just leave the gap.

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Trainer initials: _____ Date completed: _____

Introduction to FranPOS

Learn how to: Add a customer, Book an appointment, Checkout, Process refunds, Handle gift cards.

POS Tips from Playbook

- Create customer and pet profiles accurately.
- Look up existing customers by phone number.
- Share any alerts that come up on customer accounts (vaccinations, etc.).
- Follow POS icons and color codes to prevent long wait times in kennels.
- Ensure all grooming notes are documented clearly in FranPOS - if it's not in FranPOS, it doesn't exist.

Color Coding - Appointment Status

- Pink: Appointment requested online - needs to be approved and updated to in-store SKU.
- Blue: Appointment booked. A thick blue line = pet parent is 5+ minutes late - call them.
- Yellow: Service underway. Text pet parent 15 minutes before done. Thick yellow = running over time.
- Green: Service complete - call pet parent for pickup. Thick green = pet parent is late for pickup.
- Gray: Service and payment complete. Pet has left.

Core Skills Every Sales Associate Must Demonstrate

- Ring up a customer (barcode scan and manual SKU lookup).
- Book a new customer - create customer and pet profile from scratch.
- Book an existing customer - always look up by phone number first.
- Process a refund from start to finish.
- Issue and activate a gift card.
- Send a message to a customer directly from FranPOS.

I Topic completed - trainer initials: _____ Date: _____

Trainer initials: _____ Date completed: _____

Receiving Product Deliveries

Understand the difference between Woof Gang Marketplace deliveries vs. non-Marketplace deliveries. Each has a different receiving process.

Inventory Management

- First Saturday of every month: Inventory day.
- Perform weekly inventory checks on grooming supplies.
- Notify management of any inventory that needs to be reordered.
- Replenish inventory on the floor, dust off items, rearrange to showcase new products and fill wall holes.

I Topic completed - trainer initials: _____ Date: _____

PAYMENT AND SERVICE RECOVERY AUTHORITY

- Only management may approve refunds, complimentary services, discounts, credits, or veterinary reimbursements.

Trainer initials: _____ Date completed: _____

Handling Customer Complaints

Role-play common situations and review the manager escalation procedure. At any moment a complaint escalates, have the customer speak to a manager.

Complaint Resolution Steps

Step 1 - Empathize & Offer

- Listen attentively to customer concerns.
- Listen and acknowledge the concern; refer any complimentary service, discount or refund request to management.

Step 2 - Escalate if Needed

- If a customer is very upset, a full refund can be offered at management's discretion (rare - no more than once every six weeks).

If a Customer Reports Injury or Illness

- Show care, empathy, and concern for the pet's well-being.
- Advise them to visit a vet if they have any concerns.
- Assure them their pet's well-being is our top priority and we will follow up within 24 hours.
- If a vet bill reimbursement is requested, management will review.

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Store Policies

dress code, attendance, and phone use.

Some sections are marked Draft and should be reviewed and confirmed by Kyle or Julie before treating as final policy.

Arrival, Breaks & Closing Duties

Before Your Shift

Be ready to work 10–15 minutes before your first appointment or the store opens - clocked in and set up, not just walking through the door.

During the Day

Keep doors in and out of the back closed at all times. If you need a break scheduled into your day, let Kyle or Julie know.

End-of-Day Cleaning

- Crates & bathing areas wiped down.
- Grooming tables cleaned and sanitized.
- Floors vacuumed and Swiffered.
- Bathtubs cleaned - no hair residue - and disinfected.

Dress Code

Draft - confirm with Kyle or Julie before treating as final.

Clean, professional attire appropriate for a pet grooming and retail environment. Closed-toe, non-slip shoes are required. Wear your Woof Gang apparel or name tag if one has been provided. Avoid strong perfume or cologne - some dogs and customers are sensitive to it.

Attendance & Time Off

Draft - confirm with Kyle or Julie before treating as final.

Running Late or Calling Out

Call or text your manager as early as possible - not a coworker, and not after your shift was supposed to start.

Leaving Early

Any effect of early departure on guaranteed compensation is governed by the written pay agreement and applicable law; ask management.

Requesting Time Off

Request time off as far in advance as you can. Use the scheduling request form - Management will share the link with you.

Cell Phone Use

Draft - confirm with Kyle or Julie before treating as final.

Phones stay off the floor and out of sight while working with customers or pets. Only take photos of a customer's pet for social media if the pet parent has said it's okay.

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Daily / Weekly Task Routine

(inventory, lapsed customer calls, etc.).

Refer to the Playbook Routines for the full daily AM/PM checklist and weekly tasks: inventory, lapsed customer calls, etc.

Store Opening

- Disarm alarm (Port Washington only)
- Unlock front door
- Turn on lights
- Clock in on POS
- Check music is running
- Bring out signs; take lids off jars
- Check phone for voicemails or missed calls and follow up
- Contact any dogs scheduled for the current day that are not confirmed
- Clean the retail area (smells good, no dust, floors clean)
- Review the schedule for today AND tomorrow
- Check all rabies vaccinations & waivers are current in FranPOS
- Confirm all appointments 24 hours in advance to reduce no-shows

Throughout the Day

- Greet every customer the moment they enter - make eye contact, use the pet's name
- Check on laundry
- Assist customers - in store, new bookings, missed calls
- Confirm tomorrow's appointments by phone (before noon)
- Text customers who didn't confirm by phone
- Accept online bookings
- Fill cancellations by contacting future appointments and offering early spots

Store Closing

- Chalkboard with names for next day
- Take out trash
- Clean grooming/bathing station (tubs, tables, hair traps)
- Vacuum and Swiffer floor
- Clean crates and put fresh towels
- Bring in all signs; put lids back on jars
- Count and reconcile register drawer
- Check phone for new voicemails or missed calls since opening
- Turn off lights; lock front door
- Set alarm (Port Washington only)

Lapsed Customer Calls

Trainer initials: _____ Date completed: _____

TRAINING MODULE 20

- Call lapsed customers during slow periods - mid-morning or early afternoon work best.
- Track every call in the POS.
- Best cadence: manager-defined routine per store.

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Trainer initials: _____ Date completed: _____

ADDITIONAL OPERATING POLICIES

CANCELLATIONS & NO-SHOWS

- Document all cancellations and no-shows in FranPOS and use the waitlist to fill openings.
- Flag repeat same-day cancellations or no-shows to management for deposit requirements; do not promise exceptions without approval.
- Confirm current store deposit thresholds and terms with management before applying them.

PAYMENT PROCESSING

- For stores where enabled, the intended credit-card surcharge is 2.75% on eligible credit transactions only; debit and cash are excluded.
- Follow posted disclosures and POS prompts. Never manually add a surcharge to debit transactions. Escalate any uncertain card classification or customer dispute.
- Manager must confirm current activation, signage, and New York compliance before this policy is used at a location.

CUSTOMER PRIVACY & SOCIAL MEDIA

- Use customer information only for business purposes. Do not share contact details or private pet records.
- Obtain permission before posting customer pets; follow manager direction for business-account access and incident photos.

EMERGENCY RESPONSE

- Stop work, secure animals and alert management immediately in any medical, bite, escape, fire or evacuation incident.
- Seek appropriate emergency assistance; know exits, first aid supplies, emergency contacts and the store meeting point.
- Record the incident promptly; management coordinates customer contact and follow-up.

FINAL TRAINING SIGN-OFF

■ Reviewed ■ Demonstrated Safety and emergency response

■ Reviewed ■ Demonstrated Phone and appointment booking

■ Reviewed ■ Demonstrated Customer check-in and waivers

■ Reviewed ■ Demonstrated Dog weight and coat classification in FranPOS

■ Reviewed ■ Demonstrated Checkout, payment and rebooking

■ Reviewed ■ Demonstrated Late arrivals, cancellations and waitlist

■ Reviewed ■ Demonstrated Complaints and incident escalation

■ Reviewed ■ Demonstrated Opening and closing routines

Employee: _____ Store: _____

Trainer: _____ Date: _____

Manager sign-off: _____